

starts. If you remove or alter files here, the behavior of system during startup with respect to the services and daemons will get changed. It is best not to touch them by hand.

/etc/init.d/: Files in this directory are responsible for bringing up services. They are mostly symbolic links to other files in the `rc*.d` directories but a few are also original files.

More files would get available as you install more software and services. However, the rules remain the same; do not edit if you are not sure. Read the manual before you head on. For more information about a service or a command, never forget to read the man page (they stand for the ‘manua’ pages which can be read from the shell). To read the man page of a command, type `man <command_name>` on the console. For example, if you want to read the manual of the ‘ufw’ program, type `man ufw` on the command prompt. Manual pages are the ‘F1’ for a Linux application. So read them well. They might not be too friendly at once; but once you are used to it, they become immensely helpful.

Installing software offline

Installing software in Ubuntu is a piece of cake. Just launch the Ubuntu software center and type in the name of the software in the search bar; click on ‘Install’ and you have it. This all seems and sounds so easy. The part we miss is: there is an Internet connection involved. If you do not have an Internet connection, installing software on a Linux machine does not remain easy. In most cases, you cannot simply download a .DEB (or even a .RPM) file and double click to install it! There are a lot of dependencies to be resolved. Unless dependencies are resolved, the software will not behave well. Even its running is under question.

However, it is important to understand how to install software on Ubuntu without an internet connection. We show you the two ways which can get the job done. Both have their pros and cons which we will also talk about while learning about them.

Compiling programs from source code

This is the way preferred by geeks because there is no other way which can give more control over software installations. However, it is also complicated because of the technical details involved. If you have never compiled anything, may be this method is not for you. To follow this method, you must have the source code of the package you want to install. Let us take